Jillo Woche

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Summary

Senior frontend-focused Full Stack Engineer with 6+ years building React, TypeScript, and Node.js applications across enterprise SaaS and blockchain products. Experienced designing performant frontend architectures, integrating Web3 technologies, and delivering intuitive user experiences that scale. Passionate about building polished products, solving complex technical problems, and collaborating across engineering, design, and product teams.

Experience

Senior Frontend Engineer

Rainforest Alliance • Nairobi, Kenya 10/2025 - Present

- Architected and delivered 20+ production-grade features across a large-scale enterprise platform serving global certification and consumer data collection workflows.
- Collaborated on CI/CD pipelines and automated deployments using Azure DevOps
- Led frontend architecture decisions involving React, TypeScript, TanStack Query, Redux/Zustand, authentication flows, and application state management.
- Designed and maintained a reusable design system that improved UI consistency, accelerated feature delivery, and enabled polished, accessible user experiences.
- Collaborated closely with backend engineers on API contracts, authentication mechanisms, organization-aware access control, and frontend-backend integration architecture.
- Improved platform accessibility, performance, and developer experience through reusable component patterns, testing standards, and engineering best practices.
- Contributed to hiring, technical assessments, code reviews, and engineering standards while mentoring fellow frontend engineers.

Full Stack Software Engineer

GasHawk • EMEA, remote 04/2024 - 08/2025

- Led the architecture and redevelopment of a complex multi-chain platform using React, TypeScript, Node.js, ethers.js, Wagmi, RainbowKit and cloud-based infrastructure.
- Designed and implemented backend APIs, authentication systems, account management workflows, and subscription-based business logic supporting thousands of transactions.
- Solved complex integration challenges across blockchain networks, third-party providers, payment systems, and external APIs.
- Improved platform performance, reliability, and scalability through architectural improvements, caching strategies, optimized API communication, and frontend performance enhancements.
- Collaborated with product stakeholders to translate business requirements into scalable technical solutions while maintaining a high standard of code quality and testing.

Full Stack Software Engineer

IOTA • Nairobi, Kenya 11/2023 - 04/2024

- Built backend systems to automate the exchange of SPS documents between IOTA and partners, reducing manual steps and improving process reliability.
- Revamped the TLIP web app frontend with React and TypeScript, enhancing usability and delivering a smoother, more responsive user experience.

Full Stack Software Engineer

Syndicate • EMEA, remote 04/2021 - 03/2023

- Built and deployed a production-ready Web3 dApp in under 3 months (TypeScript, React, Ethereum/Polygon), accelerating Syndicate's go-to market timeline.
- Launched Collectives, enabling NFT-based communities to organize around generative art and driving early engagement among creators and collectors.
- Designed and delivered a GraphQL backend for storing off-chain data in just one month, improving data accessibility and reducing integration complexity.
- Increased smart contract reliability by implementing a comprehensive automated testing suite, reducing the risk of regressions and strengthening security.

Frontend Engineer

Cellulant • Nairobi, Kenya 11/2019 - 03/2021

- Improved accessibility and usability of payment apps by redesigning flows in React/Next.js.
- Optimized the checkout UX across 6+ payment options, resulting in smoother transaction completion.

Full-Stack Software Engineer

Andela Kenya Ltd • Nairobi, Kenya 11/2018 - 09/2019

- Delivered multiple front-end applications with ReactJS on tight sprint cycles, enabling faster product iterations and improving user experience.
- Developed and deployed a REST API with Python/Django that supported scalable data handling and reduced backend response times under production load.

Team Leader

Sama • Nairobi, Kenya 06/2016 - 11/2018

- Led a 22-person team in executing a large-scale web crawling project for Glassdoor.
- Coordinated workflows, evaluated team performance, and delivered constructive feedback that improved accuracy and efficiency.

Quality Analyst

Sama • Nairobi, Kenya 11/2015 - 05/2016

- Improved quality across multiple work streams by analyzing compliance gaps and recommending corrective actions.
- Boosted agent performance by assessing transactions, giving feedback, and driving measurable quality gains.
- Delivered clear quality reports to managers and stakeholders, ensuring consistent performance standards.

Agent Junior Developer

Sama • Nairobi, Kenya 07/2015 - 11/2015

- Optimized job feed integrations with HTML, CSS, XPaths, and regex.
- Streamlined error handling by resolving issues and improving data quality.
- Ensured accuracy at scale by verifying data and removing duplication.

Skills

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript(ECMAScript ES2023 / ES2022), SQL, Python

Frontend: React, Next.js, ethers.js, Metamask, Wagmi, WalletConnect, RainbowKit, Tanstack Query, Tanstack Router

Backend Engineering: Node.js, Fastify, Express.js, REST APIs, GraphQL, WebSockets, Authentication & Authorization, API Design

Databases & Infrastructure: PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, Vercel, Azure DevOps, CI/CD.

Testing & Tooling: Vitest, React Testing Library, Playwright, Jest, Git, GitHub Actions

AI & Developer Productivity: AI code review, AI-assisted testing, Claude, AI-assisted software development, LLM-powered developer tooling, Prompt engineering, refactoring, documentation.

Architecture & Practices: Clean Architecture, SOLID Principles, Component Architecture, Responsive Design, Accessibility (WCAG), Performance Optimisation, Agile Development.

Technical Leadership

- Defined engineering hiring criteria and created frontend technical assessments.
- Led design system adoption across teams.
- Mentored engineers through code reviews and architectural discussions.
- Collaborated with product, design, and backend teams on platform-wide technical decisions.
- Established frontend engineering standards around testing, accessibility, and maintainability.

Links

- Website: **https://jillowoche.dev**
- LinkedIn: **https://linkedin.com/in/jilloabdullahi**
- Github: **https://github.com/jillo-abdullahi**

Education

Information Technology

Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology, • Nairobi, Kenya 01/2015

Graduated with First Class Honors.

References

Available upon request.